SOP-006: Vaccine and Pharmaceutical Shipments

Document ID: SOP-006

Owner: Quality Assurance (QA) Department

Applies to: All shipments containing vaccines, insulin, or biologics

1. Purpose

Vaccines lose effectiveness if they get too warm or freeze, and damaged vaccines may not look any different. This SOP sets stricter rules for pharmaceutical cargo.

2. Temperature Rules

- Vaccines must stay between **2°C and 8°C** at all times.
- **Any** reading above 8°C, even for a short time, is a **Tier 1 breach** for vaccines. (This is stricter than for fresh perishables.)
- **Any** reading below 0°C (freezing) is also a **Tier 1 breach**. Frozen vaccines must never be delivered.

3. Required Actions After a Vaccine Temperature Breach

1. Escalate as **Tier 1** (see SOP-002): Shift Lead within 15 minutes.
2. Notify the **QA Manager immediately**, not within 1 hour as for other cargo.
3. **Quarantine** the shipment: it must not be delivered until QA approves it in writing.
4. Save the full temperature log for the trip. QA and the manufacturer will use it to decide whether the vaccines are still safe.
5. Inform the customer that the shipment is on hold for quality review.

4. Documentation

Every vaccine shipment must keep a complete temperature log from pickup to delivery. Missing sensor data for more than 1 hour on a vaccine shipment must be reported to QA.